

It's going to take some getting used to, so you will require some patience.

While you are drawing, hold down the spacebar to pan the image when you reach the edge of the document. To get a nice, clean cutout, stay just a tiny bit inside the edge of the fruit. As you draw, you should start seeing the Fresco-ed fruit appear inside the region. Once you've made it all the way around, close the path by clicking on the first control point.



What your Layers palette will look like

You can now adjust the shape of the vector mask whenever you want by using the Direct Selection Tool ([A]) .

8.5 Workshop: Cleaning Up Photographs

Thanks to inexplicable debauchery on the part of cameras and ambient light, casual photographs, especially close-ups, aren't the most flattering. Here's how you can turn an ordinary photo into a softer, more professional-looking one.

Take a look at *girl_face.jpg* in the *\Fast Track Workshops\Chapter 5* folder on the CD. It isn't really a bad photo, but it would be nice if skin texture was a little smoother.

Step I: Deception

To start with, duplicate the Background Layer. We'll first apply a Gaussian blur to soften the skin. Go to *Filter > Blur > Gaussian Blur* and set the radius to a low value—depending on what you're working on, it should be between 1 and 3 pixels for a good balance between too little and too much detail. Keep an eye on the skin to see what you like best—we'll sort out the remaining later. We used a radius of 1.6 pixels for this.